Mile Marker #6: My Academic Plan

Not a final decision. A starting point for the conversation with your Success Coach.

You don't have to have everything figured out. What this Mile Marker asks is simpler than that: What did your interest results tell you? What's one direction worth exploring? What do you need to ask your advisor? And what could your next semester realistically look like? Those four things are enough to walk into an advising appointment and have a real conversation.

You can also attach your Academic Planner if you'd like. That's your choice.

Two ways to use this handout. It matches the Mile Marker #6 assignment in Blackboard. Print it and fill it in by hand, or type in the boxes below and save a PDF. Either way, upload the photo, scan, or PDF to the assignment. You can also type your answers in Blackboard instead.

NAME _____ **DATE** _____

QUESTION 1

Your Interest Results

*After completing the Career Coach assessment (or the O*NET Interest Profiler), what did you find out about yourself?*

***A strong answer** names your top interest types, says honestly whether they fit you, and connects your results to at least one career direction.*

- What were your top two or three interest types, and do they feel accurate?
- What career matches came up that surprised you, confirmed something, or left you curious?
- What did the results suggest about the kind of work environment or people you might thrive with?

QUESTION 2

One Direction Worth Exploring

Based on your results and your own instincts, name one program or pathway at OCTC you want to know more about.

***A strong answer** names one real OCTC program, explains why that credential type fits your goals and how it differs from the other options, and is honest about what you still need to find out.*

- What program are you considering, and why does it feel worth exploring?
- Which credential type (certificate, diploma, AAS, or AA/AS) fits your goals right now, and why?
- How is that credential different from the other options, and would a transfer pathway matter for your plans?
- What do you already know about it, and what do you still need to find out?
- Is there anything about it that feels uncertain or doesn't quite fit yet?

QUESTION 3

Your Questions for Your Success Coach

Write five specific questions to bring to your advising appointment, in priority order, most important first.

***A strong answer** lists five real, specific questions in priority order, with at least one about transfer, financial aid, or course sequence.*

- Make them about your situation, your program interest, and your timeline, not questions any student could ask.
- Include at least one question about transfer, financial aid, or the order you need to take courses in.

Question 1 (most important)

Question 2

Question 3

Question 4

Question 5

QUESTION 4

Your Next Semester

Sketch a realistic course load for your next semester. The Academic Planner can help.

***A strong answer** names specific courses and an approximate credit load, explains why it's realistic for your life, and mentions one thing about sequence or prerequisites. It's a draft. Your Success Coach will help you finalize it.*

- Which courses are you thinking about, and about how many credit hours would that be?
- Why is that load realistic with your work, family, and other commitments?
- What did you learn about prerequisites or course sequence that shaped your choices?